



“Blended learning is a force multiplier. A move to a \$30-trillion economy would require a multiple-fold increase in managerial capacity. Residential programmes alone cannot meet this scale”

Q: What is your sense of job placements this year, and how can industry and academia respond to any dips?

A: Industry engagement should not be limited to placements, as they are only an outcome. Engagement must begin during the transformation stage, ensuring students understand current industry practices. That is why our core curriculum is taught by faculty and

electives by numerous industry practitioners.

Faculty must remain updated on industry practices. Research advances knowledge, but faculty must also understand how new technologies affect organisations. We engage deeply with industry through executive education and consulting. In consulting, faculty work closely with companies, understand their challenges and develop solutions—gaining practical insight on applying theory.

In executive education, I don’t think industry people come to learn from us. We do impart education to them, but at the same time, we learn a lot from industry people because in interactive discussions in classrooms, they bring out the nuances of what is happening in the industry.

Industry engagement must, therefore, be holistic—from teaching to consulting to executive education—with knowledge flowing back into the curriculum. Placements as an outcome will automatically happen if the institute is involved in an integrated fashion with industry.

Q: What will the management classroom of the future look like?

A: Even before Covid, technology made blended and online classrooms feasible. The pandemic only accelerated the adoption. Blended learning will grow for two reasons.

First, a growing economy cannot rely only on training fresh graduates. People already in the industry must be prepared for new technologies, management practices, and transitions from technical to managerial roles. Working with mid- and senior-management professionals has always been important, and technology now removes many physical-meeting constraints. Executive education increasingly uses hybrid formats where leaders spend some time on campus and learn the rest while working.

Second, blended learning is a force multiplier. A move from a \$5-trillion to a \$30-trillion economy would require a multiple-fold increase in managerial capacity. Residential programmes alone cannot meet this scale.

That is why we launched the Blended Post Graduate Programme in Management (BPGP), a blended MBA-equivalent programme for working professionals, which is now in its second batch.

We are also launching an MBA in Business Analytics and AI, because the modern manager must be technology-savvy.